Long-Term Project Assignment

Course: 07.08500 Foundations of Investing and Finance

Personal Finance Consulting Challenge: "Life After Centennial"

Course: 07.42600 Financial Literacy
School: Centennial High School, Roswell, Georgia
Project Type: Team-Based Business Simulation
Required Team Size: Minimum 3 Students
Project Duration: Minimum 10 Hours of Class Time
Presentation Required: Yes

Project Overview

In this project, student teams will operate as a **Personal Financial Consulting Firm** hired to develop a comprehensive financial plan for a fictional Centennial High School senior preparing for life after graduation.

Students will analyze realistic financial situations that reflect the choices facing many Centennial students, including:

- Four-year college pathways
- Technical college/trade school pathways
- Military service
- Immediate employment
- Entrepreneurship/start-up opportunities
- Living independently in Metro Atlanta

The project simulates real-world financial planning services provided by banks, financial advisors, and wealth management professionals.

Students will use critical thinking, research, budgeting, decision-making, and collaboration skills to create recommendations for their client.

Essential Question

How can young adults make informed financial decisions that support long-term financial success?

Business Simulation Scenario

Your team has been hired by **Centennial Financial Advisors**, a local financial consulting company.

The company specializes in helping high school seniors transition into adulthood by creating personalized financial plans.

Your consulting team has been assigned a client and must develop recommendations regarding:

- Education and career choices
- Budgeting
- Housing
- Transportation
- Banking
- Credit management
- Insurance
- Investing
- Taxes
- Emergency savings
- Long-term wealth building

At the conclusion of the project, teams will present their recommendations to a panel acting as potential clients.

Learning Objectives

Students will:

Financial Literacy Skills

- Create and manage budgets
- Analyze income and expenses
- Evaluate credit options
- Compare banking products
- Calculate loan costs
- Understand taxes and payroll deductions
- Develop savings and investment strategies
- Assess financial risk

Employability Skills

- Teamwork
- Communication
- Professional presentation
- Problem solving
- Research
- Project management
- Decision making

Project Requirements

Each team must complete the following components.

Part 1: Client Profile

Develop a detailed profile for your assigned client.

Include:

- Age
- Career goal
- Post-secondary plan

- Expected salary
- Family situation
- Financial challenges
- Personal goals

Example:

Emma is an 18-year-old Centennial graduate planning to attend the University of Georgia to study Marketing while working part-time.

Part 2: Career and Income Analysis

Research:

- Target career
- Required education
- Average beginning salary
- Five-year salary projection
- Employment outlook

Deliverables:

- Career research summary
- Income analysis chart

Part 3: Housing Decision

Students must compare at least three housing options.

Examples:

- Living with parents
- Apartment in Roswell
- Shared apartment with roommates
- Student housing

Required Analysis:

- Monthly rent
- Utilities
- Transportation costs
- Advantages/disadvantages

Part 4: Spending Plan

Create a realistic monthly budget using projected income.

Budget categories must include:

- Housing
- Transportation
- Food
- Phone
- Insurance
- Entertainment
- Savings
- Investments
- Emergency fund

The budget must balance.

Part 5: Banking and Credit Plan

Research and recommend:

- Checking account
- Savings account
- Credit card for young adults

Explain:

- Fees
- Interest rates
- Benefits
- Risks

Students must demonstrate understanding of responsible credit use.

Part 6: Insurance and Risk Management

Determine which types of insurance the client needs.

Options may include:

- Health insurance
- Auto insurance
- Renters insurance
- Life insurance

Students must justify recommendations.

Part 7: Investing for the Future

Create an investment strategy.

Include:

- Emergency savings account
- Retirement account
- Basic investments

Students must explain:

- Risk
- Return
- Diversification
- Compound growth

Part 8: Financial Recommendation Report

Each team will prepare a professional consulting report that summarizes all recommendations.

The report should be professional but concise.

Final Presentation

Presentation Focus

The presentation should focus on:

Process (Primary Focus)

Teams should explain:

- Research methods
- Financial decisions made
- Challenges encountered
- Problem-solving strategies
- Team collaboration process
- Why recommendations were selected

Product (Secondary Focus)

Students should briefly showcase:

- Final budget
- Financial plan
- Consulting report

The completed project should be presented as evidence of learning but should **not be the primary focus** of the presentation.

Presentation Requirements

Team Participation

- Minimum of 3 students presenting
- All team members must speak
- Each student must present for approximately equal time

Presentation Length

- 10 to 15 minutes

Visual Requirements

Teams must prepare:

- Google Slides
- Infographic
- Financial charts
- Budget summary visuals

Class Time Allocation (Minimum 10 Hours)

Activity	Hours
Project Introduction	1
Client Development	1
Research & Data Collection	2
Budget Development	2
Banking/Credit Analysis	1
Investment & Insurance Planning	1
Report Preparation	1
Presentation Development	1
Total	10 Hours

Evidence of Critical Thinking

Students must:

- Evaluate multiple financial choices
- Defend recommendations with evidence
- Analyze trade-offs
- Compare alternatives
- Make data-driven decisions

Examples:

- College vs. technical school
- New car vs. used car
- Renting vs. living at home
- Credit card options
- Investment choices

Evidence of Teamwork

Each team will submit:

Project Management Log

Document:

- Team roles
- Meeting notes
- Assigned responsibilities
- Deadlines achieved

Individual Reflection

Students will explain:

- Their contributions
- Lessons learned

- Challenges overcome

Deliverables

Each team will submit:

✅ Client Profile

✅ Career & Income Analysis

✅ Housing Comparison

✅ Monthly Budget

✅ Banking & Credit Plan

✅ Insurance Plan

✅ Investment Strategy

✅ Professional Financial Consulting Report

✅ Presentation Slides

✅ Team Project Log

✅ Individual Reflection

Grading Rubric (100 Points)

Category	Points
Financial Research	20
Budget Accuracy	15
Critical Thinking & Decision-Making	20
Business Simulation Authenticity	15
Teamwork Documentation	10

Category	Points
Professional Report	10
Presentation Quality	10
Total	100

Industry Certification Alignment Statement

This long-term project requires students to participate in an authentic business simulation directly related to Financial Literacy standards by acting as financial consultants, analyzing realistic financial situations, applying personal finance concepts, making evidence-based recommendations, collaborating in teams of three or more, and presenting solutions through a professional consulting process. The project incorporates more than 10 hours of instructional time and demonstrates critical thinking, problem solving, communication, and teamwork while simulating real-world financial planning activities.

5. Long-Term Project Progress Update

Project Title

Personal Financial Consulting Firm: Post-Graduation Financial Planning Project

Project Overview

Student teams are serving as a **Personal Financial Consulting Firm** hired to create a comprehensive financial plan for a fictional **Centennial High School senior** preparing for life after graduation. The project requires students to apply personal finance concepts to realistic postsecondary and career pathways.

Progress to Date

Project Launch & Team Formation

- Students were assigned teams and introduced to the client scenario.
- Teams reviewed project requirements, expectations, and final presentation components.

Career Pathway Research

- Students have researched and compared multiple post-graduation options:
    - Four-year college
    - Technical college/trade school
    - Military service
    - Immediate employment
    - Entrepreneurship/start-up opportunities

Cost Analysis

- Teams have begun gathering data on:
    - Tuition and training costs
    - Housing expenses
    - Transportation costs
    - Healthcare expenses
    - Basic living expenses in Metro Atlanta

Financial Planning Development

- Students are developing realistic budgets based on their assigned pathway.
- Teams are identifying income sources, projected expenses, savings goals, and debt considerations.

Current Focus

Students are currently:

- Refining monthly and annual budgets.
- Evaluating financial trade-offs among different pathways.
- Calculating the long-term impact of education, training, and career decisions.
- Preparing recommendations that support financial stability and career success.

Upcoming Milestones

- Complete comprehensive financial plans.
- Develop professional consulting presentations.
- Justify recommendations using financial data and research.
- Present final financial plans to the class as consulting firms pitching solutions to their client.

Overall Progress

Approximately 60–70% Complete

Most teams have successfully completed research and data collection and are transitioning into the budget analysis and recommendation phase. The remaining work focuses on financial calculations, final plan development, and presentation preparation.

Skills Being Developed

- Budgeting and financial planning
- Research and data analysis
- Career and postsecondary planning
- Critical thinking and decision-making
- Collaboration and professional communication

- Presentation and consulting skills

This project provides students with a practical understanding of the financial decisions many Centennial High School seniors will face after graduation and helps them develop strategies for long-term financial success.